

UNIT 6 : Welfare State

DEFINITIONS

Welfare State : Political concept which states that the government will intervene in the social daily life of the population and help regulate the problem (poverty...)

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1RZpWKxtSjsCNvKCPcJ0aw9y41ZLvXxBep0qHjcJWP4/edit>

DATES

1939-1945 : WWII → hard times

1948 : National Health Service

CONCEPTS

Assurance, assistance

equality, equity

collective or individual responsibility

REFERENCES

State interventionism = Keynes

- **Beveridge, Social Insurance and Allied Services 1942**

Report = experts (economics, academics) commissioned by the government (Ernest Bevin = MP Department of Labour) to carry out a survey at the beginning of the 1940s.

Beveridge = liberal economist.

War, for three years already, difficult situation → necessities in life rationed (water, food, fuel)

Report = alarming but, war so, no decisions could be taken.

1948 : NHS → Atlee (1945-1951 = Labour Party VS Churchill = Conservative).

5 majors pb in GB which prevented people from living decently = **“the Five Giant Evils”**

- Want (manque)
- Ignorance (lack of education)
- Squalor (poor houses)
- Idleness (unemployment)
- Disease (inadequate health care services)

Beveridge recommends :

- comprehensive (program that covers everything) → *“at birth, marriage or death.”*, *“for unemployment, disability and retirement.”*
- universal = available for everyone → *“each will be covered for all his needs”*
- contributory = solidarity
- non-means tests = (flèche crayon de bois)
- compulsory = obligatory *“every citizen of working age”*

⇒ To what extent does Beveridge = echo of Keynes

⇒ Popular program ?

- **Lyndon B. Johnson, “Special message to the Congress proposing a Nationwide war on the sources of poverty” 1964**

- **Cameron, speech to mark the sixtieth anniversary of NHS, 2008**

Keynote speech = ouverture, preparatory.

He sets out / announces the main point of a coming conference later (about the next general elections).

A way to announce the platform for the years to come.

DATE : subprimes crisis and financial crisis but the speech in January.

Labour party = incumbent party → G. Brown.

The Labour Party will fall in third place after the conservatives and the socialist-democrats.

Cameron started politics in 2001 = backbencher (less important MPs).

Shadow cabinet (MP, frontbencher) in 2004.

→ Leader of the Conservative Party in 2005 = shadow PM.

2010 : Conservative Party won the elections.

1948 : NHS under the gov of C. Attlee → National Health Service = to provide free medical treatment for all. It became overcrowded and a victim of its popularity.

1948 : after WW2, reconstruction (economy, medical...), baby boom ⇒ population needed to be assisted.

Then, Glorious Thirty so, the number of the people in need was acceptable, feasible to help.

Political consensus = butskellism (from R. Butler, conservative & H. Gaitskell, labour

→ chancellor of the Exchequer).

1979 : Thatcher PM (conservative) changed everything, she cut the tap.

She denationalised the companies.

The NHS was redesigned and the flat-rate prescription charge began.

Now, flat-rate prescription charge (for all the medications) : private health insurance.

→ A lot of people are exempted :

- children under 16
- pregnant women
- aged people

1997: Tony Blair (labour) = New Labour → more moderate, he recognised that the people had to participate and that the State cannot do everything.

2012 : law : Health and Social Care Act → it was up to the GPs to decide which hospitals they would send their patients to, so the competition increased.

BUT :

- Long waiting list to be consulted
- The hospitals suffer from a deficit (rocketing deficit)
- Staff shortage

2020 : Covid-19 buried the all service which was rapidly overcome.

Private sectors developed.

Now : 20% of the population have private health insurance.

Iteration :

- Equity
- Patients should be the ones who decide where they want to go, they should be left the choice to be cured / treated where they want
- NHS = like an institution (x6), compared to the BBC (l.2) and to Parliament while it is not. So it should be preserved. It is a means to reassure that the conservatives will not repeal the NHS. It is important to society.

⇒ Cameron points out the core values = equity (access = fair) and equality

L.17 : "dignity".

He turns the conservative party into a more social party to gain votes.

Disraeli, Sybil or the Two Nations : wants to build a party, the society should be more equal.

→ "one-nationism"

NHS is instrumentalised by Cameron.

He wants to reform it : decentralisation (l. 40-43), to empower patients and professionals.

L. 52 : inverse care law (J. Tudor Hart) = the availability of good medical or social care tends to vary inversely with the needs of the population served. Health care has become a commodity (= product, goods), so rich people will benefit more from it, the poor don't get any of it.

- **Obama, Address on the Affordable Care Act, September 2009**

Address to the all Congress, broadcasted on TV at the same time.

2008 : Obama = Pr → landslide victory

Many people are uninsured = mostly middle class people because :

- No company insurance, so they have to pay for private insurance (x3) but it is expensive.
- When you are ill, you are in charge.
- Forbidden to get the insurance if you have been ill, even if you recovered
- If you lose your job, you lose your company insurance

L. 8 : every pr failed = "our collective failure to meet this challenge...", EX :

- Roosevelt = New Deal
- Truman = Post-War Corporate Welfare
- Johnson = Medicare and Medicaid
- Nixon = CHIP (Comprehensive Health Insurance Plan)
- Clinton = commission failed to enact a law
- Bush Jr = MMA (Medicare Modernization Act) 2003

Meritocracy in the US : shame if the State intervenes so, the ones who succeed don't want to help the others, they have to do it by themselves.

In America, lobbying is important. EX :

- Medical profession : AMA = American Medical Association
- Pharmaceutical industry : PhRMA = Pharmaceutical Research and Manufacturers of America.
- Private insurances : AHIP = America's Health Insurance Plans

Racial factors that there is no insurance.

J. Wilson kept on saying "Lie !"

ACA = Obamacare → 5 measures :

- Not possible to discriminate people on the basis of pre-existing conditions (l. 31)
- Young adults allowed to benefit from their parents' health insurance until 26
- Insurance exchanges
- Private insurances = online markets (l. 34-38)
- Individuals must prove an insurance
- To oblige the companies, with more than 50 employees, to propose an insurance

⇒ Shared responsibility between three actors :

- Individuals
- Professionals
- State

2017 : Trump tried to repeal the law several times

- **T. Helm, article "Labour "must spend billions on welfare or poverty will soar""
2024**